

whole thing isn't really about money. It's about living the right way, and money is just a facilitator to that."

Money is an extremely valuable tool in our society, so we need to understand how to use it. However, it is vital to remember that money is not the main goal when working toward FI. This is a common theme among those who have achieved FI. Carl didn't take time to develop a philosophy of money, because it was common sense to him. But most of us do need to apply thought and effort to shift our mindsets.

J.D. Roth, one of the first personal finance bloggers who now writes the popular blog *Get Rich Slowly*, thinks everyone should define his or her personal mission as clearly as possible. He encourages you to sit down and write a mission statement and be specific about what is important to you. This gives you something concrete that will guide future actions and provide a benchmark to assess those actions.

Roth is specific about actually *writing down* your mission statement. While it is not clear how many people follow this specific advice, a very clear pattern emerges when studying people who have achieved or are close to achieving FI. Nearly all determine their